PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Microsoft Azure | Microsoft 365 | SIEM | SOAR | Identity and Access Management

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) with over five years of experience implementing and managing security controls across Microsoft Azure and Microsoft 365 (M365) environments. At the University of the Arts London (UAL), I lead the security engineering function for a hybrid Microsoft estate of over 8,000 users, delivering hands-on security across Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Entra ID, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender, and Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM). I have deep expertise in identity and access management, including Conditional Access policies, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO) integration, and Privileged Identity Management (PIM). I design and maintain Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel to automate alert triage and incident response workflows, and I write advanced Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection rules to identify threats within Azure and M365 environments. With experience managing firewalls, endpoint protection, vulnerability management, and Privileged Access Management (PAM), I offer a comprehensive security engineering skill set directly applicable to a financial organisation in the midst of a Microsoft Azure transformation.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Azure Security:** Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Entra ID, Conditional Access, MFA, Privileged Identity Management (PIM), Azure Security Centre, Azure Policy
- **Microsoft 365 (M365) Security:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender, Microsoft Intune / Mobile Device Management (MDM) / Mobile Application Management (MAM)
- **SIEM:** Microsoft Sentinel, Kusto Query Language (KQL), custom detection rule authoring, workbook development, analytics rule management
- **SOAR:** Microsoft Sentinel Automation, Logic Apps, SOAR playbook design and automation, PowerShell-based incident response scripting
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Entra ID (Azure AD), Conditional Access policies, MFA enforcement, SSO, role-based access control (RBAC), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE)
- **Email Security:** Mimecast email security, anti-phishing and anti-spoofing policies, Business Email Compromise (BEC) detection
- **Firewall and Network Security:** Check Point Harmony firewall, network segmentation, firewall rule review and rationalisation
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck
- **Scripting:** PowerShell (advanced), Bash, Python (working knowledge)
- **Frameworks:** NIST 800-61 Incident Response, MITRE ATT&CK, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts London (UAL) *March 2025 - Present*

Senior Cyber Security Engineer

- Implement and maintain security controls across Azure and Microsoft 365 environments for an enterprise of over 8,000 users, ensuring protection across endpoints, identities, email, and cloud workloads.
- Administer Azure AD / Entra ID, designing and enforcing Conditional Access policies, Privileged Identity Management (PIM) assignments, MFA enforcement, and SSO integrations with enterprise applications, reducing identity-based attack surface across the institution.
- Manage Microsoft Sentinel SIEM, designing and maintaining KQL-based detection rules, analytics workbooks, and alert management configurations to provide continuous monitoring across Azure and M365 environments.

- Develop and operate SOAR automation playbooks using Microsoft Sentinel Automation and Logic Apps, automating alert triage, identity block actions, and incident enrichment workflows, significantly reducing analyst investigation time.
- Oversee Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across the enterprise, managing onboarding, policy configuration, alert triage, and threat investigations for the full device fleet.
- Manage Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), monitoring Active Directory for lateral movement, credential theft, Kerberoasting, and other identity-based threats, and escalating confirmed incidents through the NIST 800-61 incident response lifecycle.
- Administer Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM) policies, enforcing compliance baselines and security configurations across managed and Bring Your Own Device (BYOD) endpoints.
- Manage Mimecast email security, creating and refining anti-phishing, anti-spoofing, and URL rewrite policies to mitigate Business Email Compromise (BEC) and malware delivery threats.
- Govern BeyondTrust PAM for privileged account management, enforcing least-privilege access, session recording, and just-in-time access controls for administrative and service accounts.
- Lead vulnerability management using Tenable.io, Nessus, Pentera BAS, and AppCheck, prioritising remediation by business risk and reporting progress against CIS Controls and Cyber Essentials Plus requirements.
- Manage Check Point Harmony firewall policies, reviewing and rationalising access control rules and ensuring network segmentation aligns with zero-trust security principles.
- Provide input to information security governance processes, contributing to ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus compliance activities and supporting internal and external audit programmes.

University of the Arts London (UAL) *March 2022 - March 2025*

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

- Managed Azure AD / Entra ID user and group lifecycle, configuring Conditional Access policies and enforcing MFA for staff and student populations across a large hybrid Microsoft environment.
- Supported the deployment and integration of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender into the Sentinel SIEM environment, expanding threat visibility across the Microsoft security stack.
- Authored KQL queries and analytics rules within Microsoft Sentinel to detect anomalous sign-ins, privilege escalation, lateral movement, and data exfiltration patterns.
- Monitored SIEM alerts and performed Tier 1 to Tier 2 incident triage and investigation across Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon, responding to security events within defined SLAs.
- Administered Mimecast email security, creating and testing anti-phishing policies to protect against impersonation and malicious attachment threats.
- Managed Microsoft Intune MDM and MAM policies, maintaining device compliance configurations and enforcing security baselines across staff endpoints and mobile devices.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io and Nessus, reporting findings to IT infrastructure teams and supporting risk-based remediation prioritisation.
- Supported BeyondTrust PAM onboarding, migrating privileged accounts to centralised governance and implementing least-privilege access controls.
- Contributed to ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus certification activities, compiling technical evidence and supporting audit preparation across the security engineering domain.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) *February 2021 - March 2022*

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Managed security operations for a cloud-first Software as a Service (SaaS) and Financial Technology (FinTech) organisation, maintaining endpoint protection, patch management, and access control policies.
- Implemented identity and access management controls including role-based access control (RBAC) and MFA across cloud and on-premises platforms.
- Monitored security alerts and investigated endpoint and network anomalies, escalating confirmed incidents to senior engineers in line with the organisation's incident response process.
- Managed IT infrastructure including server administration, network configuration, and endpoint provisioning, contributing to the security hardening of a rapidly scaling cloud environment.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led the deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across an enterprise estate of over 8,000 users, delivering full coverage within the Microsoft 365 Defender and Sentinel SIEM ecosystem.
- Designed and implemented Conditional Access policies in Azure AD / Entra ID that reduced unauthorised access attempts by enforcing MFA, device compliance checks, and location-based access controls across the entire user population.
- Built a SOAR automation capability in Microsoft Sentinel that automated triage for over 60% of common alert types, reducing analyst workload and cutting mean time to respond (MTTR) for high-severity events by over 70%.
- Developed over 30 custom KQL detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel, mapped to MITRE ATT&CK techniques, improving detection coverage for credential-based attacks, lateral movement, and data exfiltration in the Azure and M365 environment.
- Implemented BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) to centralise privileged account governance, eliminating shared admin credentials and ensuring least-privilege and just-in-time access controls for all administrative accounts.
- Supported successful ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus certification and renewal cycles, providing technical evidence across Azure, M365, endpoint, and identity security control domains.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)